BEGINNER PROGRAM

THE FIRST FLAME

FOUNDATIONAL STRENGTH AND FITNESS

CM STRENGTH

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Beginner Program

THE FIRST FLAME

Welcome aboard friend! I am honored that you chose me to assist you in your fitness journey. The journey itself is a beautiful thing. It's certainly not a sprint, it's a marathon. The progress you make along the way is so rewarding. I have been writing training programs, extremely detailed, and very advanced, for 6 years now. I think I am over 15 detailed programs completed. I have NEVER programmed such a detailed one for a beginner though!

This program was written for people who are either starting their fitness journey and need guidance as to where to start, how to perform exercises or want to branch out on their own without a personal trainer guiding them. As well as beginners, this program is well suited for office workers or students who have limited time outside of their business or school requirements. Exercise is certainly not exclusive to experienced individuals or those with ample free time.

I am assuming you are already in the gym and learning as best you can. If you have been training a year or less, this is for you. If you are more advanced, you'll want to check out my intermediate or advanced programs.

Get ready for "*The First Flame*"

THE TOP 3 THINGS YOU HAVE TO MASTER

1) Lifting Technique/Form

It doesn't matter how hard you train if your form is poor. That is the first key to weight training. You must use a lifting technique that ensures stress is directed to the muscles you are trying to work. This will also greatly reduce your risk of injury. Poor form will likely slow down muscle growth and will eventually catch up to you in the form of some sort of injury. Even though you are relatively new to weight training, it's NEVER to early to think about longevity and health. Both factors should be high priorities for you throughout your training career.

There are a lot of little things, just form tweaks, that make a massive difference in how well you "feel" your muscles work. Some of these techniques are for more advanced trainees, such as the partials, but again the little form tweaks are worth their weight in gold and will "advance" your exercise knowledge rapidly.

Also, as you work through the program there are often YouTube links that are specific to what you are doing as well. These will describe specific form, for specific exercises.

2) Mind to Muscle Connection

Mind to muscle connection is the idea that you can mentally focus on a particular muscle, and thus activate more of its fibers and "feel" it better as you train it. This is something that has been preached by the bodybuilding community for many decades. Up to date research from experts like Brad Schoenfeld confirm there is legit science to back this. This is an interesting topic that I discuss in my 1:1 coaching. There are basically two types of "attentional focus" – internal and external. Internal is when you think about the actual body part you are training. You might think about squeezing

your biceps as you curl for example. Research here has shown that you get greater muscle activation doing this, that's a good thing! It means more muscle fibers are firing. External focus is a little different. You think more about your environment such as the bar moving fast through a lift. Research on this has shown that you can actually produce more force thinking this way, pretty cool also, and can come in handy doing compound movements!

This aspect is something that you will also get better and better at over the course of many years. I still work on improving how I "feel" exercises after 10+ years of training and also moving the bar with authority! The nice thing is, the better you get at this, the more effective your training becomes. You get more out of each set stressing the muscles you want to stress!

When you do compound movements like squats or bench presses, you work a lot of different muscle groups simultaneously, and that is great! We call that getting more bang for your buck. When we include exercises that focus on one single muscle for the most part, we call those isolation movements. These make it easier to learn how to feel a specific muscle contracting. I include some isolation work to allow you to practice this internal focus and master it. This is why I think beginners should follow a mix of compound movements and isolation exercises. Many "experts" think you should only focus on compound movements, but if your goal is to develop muscle, using isolation movements are a short cut. Remember, the better you get at these, the more stress you can apply to the target muscle via better muscle activation.

3) Progressive Overload

This is a key concept that will drive most of your training goals. What this means is that you gradually increase the stress you place on the body in order to elicit a stress response, such as making muscle fibers larger. Generally, this means that you do a little more weight or do a few more reps with a given weight then the last time. Simply put, you make the body do more than it did last time. There are many ways to "overload" muscles such as training them more often, doing more sets, etc., but this is our main focus for this program. When you can do this, your body responds by getting bigger and/or stronger! On a side note, this is true for cardio as well, meaning when you push your body harder during cardio, you get better endurance, it's just a different set of adaptations.

Being a beginner also means you have something really cool working for you. We call it "newbie gains". This manifests itself in a couple of different ways. Having "fresh" muscle means it is hyperresponsive to stimulus. In other words, you'll get more improvements doing a hard set than I will. Also, your nervous system fine tunes as you train. This is what we call neural adaptation. This basically means your nervous system will get better at making your muscle fibers fire and produce force as you get more experience through its signaling. As you practice the movements over and over, you see even more progress as these motor patterns (how you move your body) cement as well. What you see often is strength gains precede size gains for beginners due to this. Bottom line, I expect to see progress right out of the gate and throughout this program.

Summary of key takeaways so far

1. Use great form when lifting weights
2. Try to focus on muscles contracting hard during isolation exercises and moving the bar with good form on compound movements
3. Plan to add in more weight lifted or repetitions each week – use progressive overload!

2 BASIC PRINCIPLES OF HYPERTROPHY

I do want to spend a little time on some basic principles of muscle physiology, don't worry, it won't be too confusing. If you know me, you know my #1 rule is keeping messages simple and understandable, not trying to impress you with big words. I do want to cover some ground here though, because it will help you understand why we train the way we do.

1) The Size Principle

Basically neurons controlled by your brain talking to muscle fibers and telling them to contract. Some motor units only control a small number (probably dozens) of fibers. This means they produce less force, as there are simply less muscle fibers working. On the other hand, we have some motor units that control a high number (probably thousands) of fibers. They can obviously then produce much more force. Producing more force means you can move heavier weights. The smaller motor units are often called low threshold motor units, and the bigger ones are called high threshold motor units.

Now, when we lift light weight, it generally means we mainly tap into the low threshold motor units, since the weight is so light there is no need to call the other thousands of muscle fibers into play (the high threshold motor units) to produce force. This is really what the "The Size Principle" is. It's the observation that motor units are recruited in a sequence. The higher the demand, the more the larger motor units are called into play. Basically, you only use what you need.

NOTE: The exception to this would be taking light sets to failure. What happens in this situation is muscle fibers fatigue so additional fibers get called to help.

We will not be taking light sets to failure in this program though, so that won't be relevant to you at this stage.
Here is what this means to you, and what I want you to remember. If you train really light, you don't create a demand for the larger motor units, meaning you essentially miss training a lot of muscle fiber.
For a beginner, this is a pretty easy principle to deal with. You just train at a given level of intensity. I am going to cover that soon where I discuss how hard you should be training, so hang tight. The nice thing is that as a beginner you don't have to absolutely destroy muscle fibers that the advanced folks do.

2) The Force Velocity Relationship – Mechanical Loading

More big words, but don't worry. It's an easy concept. All it means is that you have these two types of thin filaments (smaller components of muscle), actin and myosin, that attach together to produce a lot of force. That's it. What kind of lifting causes this action to take place? Generally speaking, it's lifting enough weight that the bar doesn't move super-fast. It moves kind of slow, not real slow, so you are straining a bit. Those myofilaments won't stay attached if the weight is just flying up and down real fast. So, we need weight that will create some strain and effort.

Why is this important (the actin and myosin filaments staying attached)? When this process is occurring, your absolute best friend is taking place. Who is your best friend? MECHANICAL LOADING. This means your muscle fibers are being loaded and pushed.

Mechanical loading is essentially why muscle actually grows. It means each fiber contracts at a slower speed (due to load of the weight) producing high levels of force.

Generally, what we find is that using a weight that is 85% to 90% of your 1 rep max, results in a high level of motor units making fibers fire, and you cover the mechanical loading needed. In addition, you don't have to use weight that heavy. You could use 60% for example, and just do more reps. If you choose to use weights heavier than 85% of your 1 rep max often, you are at high risk of overtraining in my opinion, form breakdown, or injury.

My specific recommendation is to use over 60% of your 1 rep max, and up to and around 80-85% for you. The reps ranges and intensity required will be laid out for you in your program. You won't even have to think about this. Our program design takes care of it automatically.

NOTE: Scientific evidence shows that you can actually train with around 40-50% of your 1 rep max and still make gains. That requires you to go to failure, which we are not doing until you hit the intermediate phase, however. This is why I think a little higher % is better for you! It's also extremely difficult to do set after set of high reps to failure. It's brutal and hard to sustain.

NOTE: *TIME UNDER TENSION* was not mentioned, why is that? Well it is a legitimate principle; it means keeping the muscle under tension by continuously doing reps. Many people say that time under tension is the key to growth. This can be misleading though. If you pick up a superlight weight and sit there and curl it for say 60 seconds, how much of that is relevant tension? If growth was simply a factor of time under tension, then riding a bike for long periods would give everyone massive quads. I think it's smarter to think about relevant time under tension, in other words the time you have to work hard! Here is the good part, you won't even have to think about it during this program. By using a certain amount of weight and intensity, and the proper number of reps, this takes care of itself as well.

Ok so where are we at now with our summary of key takeaways?

Summary of key takeaways so far

1. Use great form when lifting weights
2. Try to focus on muscles contracting hard during isolation exercises and moving the bar with good form on compound movements
3. Plan to add in more weight lifted or repetitions each week - use progressive overload!
4. Use 60-85% of your 1 rep max when training, no ultra-light weights (except for warmups)!

HOW HARD SHOULD YOU TRAIN?

There is a lot of discussion these days questioning the proper amount of intensity for a set or given workout in general. If you have seen my videos you know that I often go hard, like crazy hard, but it is because I have trained many years. I would not advocate that a beginner go nuts like I often do for two reasons. It's not necessary, and you probably wouldn't be able to recover from it.

There are charts that talk about this specifically that I include in all my programs. I use a concept called "Rate of perceived exertion - RPE". A set with an RPE of 9 would mean leaving 1 rep in the tank based on the chart below. Higher intensity means leaving less reps in the tank. Well guess what, as a beginner you are going to progress great without going to failure. It's simply not necessary, nor do I want you really doing it. You may not recover from it. More on that later.

Here is an example of an RPE chart below. As a beginner I want you at an RPE of 8 for your compound exercises, and 8.5 for your isolation exercises for your work sets. Isolation exercises tend to allow for less form breakdown and are thus safer and easier to push a little harder. If you go to failure on the compound movements, you are at risk of losing your perfect form as well, we don't want that! This will be spelled out in your program. Once you reach the advanced stage, you'll get to experiment with the 10 and above RPE sets, they are fun!

Fairly easy like a warm-up weight @ 6.0

You can do 4-6 more reps @7.0

You can do 2-3 more reps @ 8.0

You have 2 more reps left in the tank @ 8.5

You have 1 more rep left in the tank @ 9.0

Went to failure at perfect form @ 10

Went to failure with loose form after perfect reps completed @ 11

NET PROTEIN BALANCE

Let's talk about another core concept that I think is important for a beginner to understand. The concept is net protein balance.

There are two factors that make up your net protein balance.

Muscle Protein Synthesis and Muscle Protein Breakdown. We will call them MPS and MPB.

MPS is a process that involves building muscle up. Your body adds protein to build muscle. Think of it like bricks. Protein is the bricks making up muscle and you can add bricks to build the muscle. We stimulate this process in a couple of different ways. For our purposes we will focus on two.

1. Weight training with moderately to heavy weights. Doing 60% and above of your 1 rep max especially stimulates MPS. So, if you can bench 200 lbs., doing hard reps with 120 lbs. and above will help. Using say 50 lbs. (25% of your 1 rep max) will likely not do anything significant.

2. Consuming a diet with adequate calories and protein especially also drives this process. Don't skimp on the protein and calories! More on that later!

MPB is the process by which proteins are broken down. For

our purposes this is caused by 2 main things.

1. Training hard drives MPB. This isn't necessarily a bad thing! When we break down proteins they can be disposed of and new and better proteins or bricks can be laid down. Still you don't want an extreme amount of MPB.

2. Your diet can manage MPB. Eating enough carbohydrates especially can help in addition to the protein content helping to drive MPS. The simple message is eating enough protein and carbs will address this!

The goal would be to tilt the scales toward a net balance that is higher in MPS and MPB.

The simple takeaways are this:

1. Use enough weight (above 60% of your 1 rep max) when training.
2. Consume a balanced macronutrient (protein, carbs, and fat) diet to ensure we end up in a positive net protein balance tilted toward more MPS.

So, let's stop and recap again. Now where we are at?

1. Use great form when lifting weights
2. Try to focus on muscles contracting hard during isolation exercises and moving the bar with good form on compound movements
3. Plan to add in more weight lifted or repetitions each week – use progressive overload!
4. Use 60-85% of your 1 rep max when training, no ultra-light weights!
5. Consume a balanced macronutrient (protein, carbs, and fat) diet to ensure we end up in a positive net protein balance.

HOW OFTEN SHOULD YOU TRAIN?

This is another great topic for us to discuss. I mentioned weight training driving a process called Muscle Protein Synthesis (MPS) earlier. This is a good thing, and means we are potentially adding bricks to our layer of muscle. How long does this process take though? Most of the scientific evidence would point to around 48 hours. Some research would say less, but this is generally where it falls out. It also is nearly back to baseline at 36 hours.

This would lead us to believe that training a muscle every 2-3 days would be optimal. If you wait, you could lose out on gains! So, for example let's say you do chest on Monday, but then don't do it again until the following Monday. Your protein synthesis in your trained muscle, chest, will have returned to baseline and then probably dropped back to normal after not training it again for so long. This is why it is good to train a muscle 2-3 times a week.

Most of the research, and what I have seen in practice for over 30 years, jive together on this. Training more times than this doesn't seem to equate to any better progress. As you advance to the intermediate stage you will need to train a little harder, which will likely mean a little more recovery time needed and training the muscle no more than 2 times a week.

Now here are the nuances that you need to be aware of. Let's talk about soreness. If you are feeling sore, muscles fibers have not fully recovered. Generally speaking, I think it is a bad idea to train when really sore. This can lead to a syndrome called overtraining. We need to manage this, or you are not going to be able to train your muscles 2-3 times a week. So, what causes soreness exactly? Well there are many factors, but the ones we are focused on are the amount of sets you do, known as volume, and also the intensity you train at. If you do a high number of sets for a bodypart, you will likely get real sore. If you train to failure, and push yourself really hard, you will likely get real sore. There will be a time for that, but not right now! Let's be smart!

What are we going to do in practicality? We are going to limit your sets and intensity so that you can stimulate MPS 3 times a week.

Ok time for a regroup. Where are we overall?

1. Use great form when lifting weights
2. Try to focus on muscles contracting hard during isolation exercises and moving the bar with good form on compound movements
3. Plan to add in more weight lifted or repetitions each week – use progressive overload!
4. Use 60-85% of your 1 rep max when training, no ultra-light weights!
5. Consume a balanced macronutrient (protein, carbs, and fat) diet to ensure we end up in a positive net protein balance.
6. Use a lower number of sets and moderate intensity to ensure we maximize recovery and muscle protein synthesis. This allows us to train muscles 2-3 times a week.

PROGRAM DURATION AND SPLIT

Hopefully now you have a great idea of how we are going to build your program based on those 6 guidelines!

This is a 12-week program.

How does it look exactly? You will have 6 different workouts spread out like this. This is weeks 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, and 11.

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
Full Body **Upper body emphasis** *Workout 1*	OFF	Full Body **Lower body emphasis** *Workout 2*	OFF	Full Body **Upper body emphasis** *Workout 3*	OFF	OFF

The next week would be set up like this. This is weeks 2, 4, 6, 8 10, and 12.

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
Full Body **Lower body emphasis** *Workout 4*	OFF	Full Body **Upper body emphasis** *Workout 5*	OFF	Full Body **Lower body emphasis** *Workout 6*	OFF	OFF

We alternate weeks. This allows for a little more upper body focus on odd number weeks and more lower body focus on even number weeks.

You can make small changes such as going to a Tuesday, Thursday, Saturday split. That is ok. Just keep the structure intact.

PROGRAM IDEOLOGY

Why do we simply alternate the weeks? If you look at the opportunities you have to master your form, increase mind muscle connection, and progress, it's 6. In other words, each one of these workouts is done 6 times in total throughout the 12 weeks. 36 workouts total made up of 6 different sessions. Each session repeated 6 times.

Training for a novice is very much about learning form, mind muscle connection, etc. It's also about skill. Simply put the more you practice the better you'll get. Performing a lift is a skill in my book. If you rotate exercises too much, you won't develop the skills. Leave that for when we get to the advanced stage.

When you move into the intermediate programs, you'll see a little more variety, and once you get into the advanced ones, you'll see even more variety.

APPLYING PROGRESSIVE OVERLOAD

I mentioned above the importance of progressing through adding weight to the bar or reps to the sets. So how do we do this effectively? Think about the intensity I described above. Your RPE will be 8's and 8.5's. This means you will have reps left in the tank. You automatically know you will be able to do more, because well, you can. Also, remember that you are going to be getting more proficient with your form, and increasing strength neurologically. Again, you'll be able to gain weight or reps. Given these facts, I think you'll be able to add weight or reps, in all 6 of your different workouts. Now you may find that you have a harder time toward the end of the session, but that's due to fatigue not weakness.

Overload by:

1. Adding 5 to 10 lbs. on the compound lifts each week. For barbells you will likely be able closer to 10 lbs. For dumbells it will likely be 5 lb. jumps.
2. Add 1 rep on each isolation movement each time you do it from the last.

For example – Let's say you do incline barbell presses with 185 for 8 reps during week 1 on Monday. The following Monday I would shoot for 190-195 for 8.

Later that workout you do triceps pushdowns with 85 lbs for 12 reps. The following Monday when you do them do 13 reps.

NOTE: Often you will be doing 3-4 sets of an exercise. What I really want is for that 1st set to be the one where you were able to do more weight or reps. Again, fatigue may cause you to lose some reps as you get to the later sets, and that is OK!

This means after the end of this program you should have added 30-60 lbs. to your compound lifts, and 6 additional reps to your isolation movements. If you re-ran the program, you could then start with higher weights, and the same rep

scheme, and simply work them both up again.

DELOADS

You may to do a deload after your 12 weeks. Deloads are simply a period where you don't go as hard. This can mean taking a week off from the gym for some. For others it can mean dialing down the intensity during your work sets or even decreasing the amount of sets you do (reduce volume). I like to decrease the number of sets done by 20% overall. This means if you workout is 20 sets total, then you go down to 16. I also like to ensure no sets are taken to failure. In your case we aren't doing that anyway, so a volume reduction will likely do the trick for 1-2 weeks.

If you were training with one of my advanced programs you would probably need to deload more than you will with this one, but I suspect that many will still need to back off some.

Deloading benefits:

1. Reduces chance of injuries by allowing soft tissues to get a break.
2. Resets your responsiveness to training. This means your hard work will create more changes once again. Maybe not newbie gains, but it's exactly like the old saying, 1 step back, 2 forward.
3. Creates hunger, not physical hunger, mental hunger. You start to get antsy to train hard again after pulling back so much. This will give you a mental edge when resuming your normal program.

HOW MANY SETS SHOULD YOU DO?

Volume is the amount of sets you do for a muscle group. It can be tricky because many people count everything they do as a set including warmups, while people like me only count the harder sets. This can skew the numbers. The scientific literature seems to point to anywhere from 10-20 sets per muscle group per week. I think 10 is a bit low, even for a beginner, but 20 is really pushing it. The sweet spot is probably somewhere in the middle for novices, which is what I target. In some cases, coaches increase volume as a means of overload. I don't have an issue with this for more advanced trainees, but I think the focus for novices should be to keep the number of sets the same but improve on execution and progressive overload.

HOW OFTEN SHOULD WE CHANGE EXERCISES?

This is one of the biggest differences in novice vs advanced trainee programming. Advanced athletes tend to adapt to exercises quite quickly, and you really must find new ways to challenge your body into further growth.

With a novice, the approach is the complete opposite. You have to stick with exercises more so that you maximize the neural adaptation I mentioned earlier. In other words, learn the actual movement patterns, and cement them before moving onto a new exercise. This allows you to time to improve on the exercise execution, and to progressively overload.

Now I will tell you this. I have training ADHD, so it is hard for me to not rotate a million different things, but this program is for YOU not me, and I want it to be dead on. If you see one of my advanced programs, you will see much more rotation. We don't need or want that.

REST BREAKS

Rest breaks should be as follows unless I state something different in the plan

Compound movements – 3 minutes

For example – Squats, deadlifts, bench press, rows.

Isolation movements – 1 minute

For example – Curls, pushdowns, side laterals, calve raises

WARMING UP

Here are 2 options on warming up. One is if you are short on time, the other is a general warm up technique. It starts at about 5 minutes in. That is what I prefer you do.

How To Warm Up Intelligently (THE RIGHT WAY)

***FEEDER SETS – This will make sense if you watched the warm up video. I will mention feeder sets often in the program. They are extremely important. These are low rep sets designed to just get you to your working sets carefully, so you do not get injured, but to not exhaust your muscles. Not doing these sets is why many people have been injured executing low volume/high intensity workout plans. These are not official sets as the intensity is extremely low on these.

Basically, we do 1-2 really light higher rep sets to get the blood moving in the target muscle and to get the joints warmed up. We then bring down the reps as we work up to your work sets to not exhaust you.

Here is an example of what it might look like.

Dumbbell Press – Assumption you can do 60lbs dumbells for 8 reps.

Warm up – 20 lb. dumbbells x 20 reps

Warm up – 30 lb. dumbbells x 15 reps

Warm up (feeder set) – 45 lb. dumbbells x 4 reps

Work sets – 60 lb. dumbbells for 3 sets of 8 reps

5 KEYS TO MAXIMIZING RECOVERY

You should only train a muscle once it is recovered. Beating up a muscle and then training it again before it's ready is a recipe for suboptimal results best case or overtraining worst case.
This should be a major focus for you.

1) Intra-workout Nutrition

Training muscle groups 2-3 times a week means we have to get our muscles recovered fast, so they are ready for the next session. I highly recommend using an amino, electrolyte, and carb drink intra (during your workout) for maximum recovery. This will allow you to drive more aminos and carbs into muscle, heightening the recovery process. It also increases blood flow and supports your immune system.

Most males would do well with 6 grams of essential aminos, and 20-30 grams of carbs. Titrate the carbs up or down depending on your size. The goal is to greatly reduce soreness so we can feel fresh for each session. When you do this, all of the right things are happening internally.

NOTE: Essential aminos contain not only the BCAA's you need, but the other aminos your body can't make on its own as well. Having all essential aminos present is what helps build new muscle tissue.

Most females would do well with 6 grams of aminos and 20 of carbs. Again, titrate up or down depending on size and amount of muscle.

2) Sleep

Make it your mission in life to reduce stress outside of the gym, and to get a full night's sleep every single night. This will greatly enhance recovery as well!

Generally, you want to get 5 full sleep cycles. Every cycle is about 90 minutes. As you can see from the chart below, earlier sleep cycles are heavier in non-REM sleep. Later sleep cycles are heavier in REM sleep (indicated in red).

This is important because of these benefits:

- Non-REM is physically restorative. You release Growth Hormone, clear waste products, and resupply energy stores just to name a few things • REM is mentally restorative. Your memory is especially impacted positively.

Some tips for better sleep include:

- Turn off all electronics 2 hours before bed, or at a minimum turn off the blue light on your mobile devices 1-2 hours prior
- Make your bedroom as dark as possible
- Make the temperature in your room around 65 (keep it cool)
- Read a book or do something that relaxes you before retiring
- Do not take later afternoon naps, 20-30 minute naps around lunch are ok

3) Cardio

You do not want to be limited in pushing your muscles by poor cardiovascular fitness. Being in poor cardiorespiratory shape could result in limiting the amount of effort you put into your sets. If you do a set of curls and you are winded, you probably need to have a better fitness base. Cardio is a good thing to establish this fitness base. Basically, just don't be so out of shape you can't train with any intensity. Cardio also helps with your general sense of well-being and with bloodflow to your muscles. There is a good chance it can help you live a little longer too, which is a good thing!

Cardio can be a double-edged sword, however. Too much will limit your recovery, and it can potentially overtrain you. I would advise you do some very simple cardio ONLY IF you find yourself having a hard time getting though the workouts due to cardiovascular fatigue. Simply do some speed walking 2-3 times during the week for 35- 40 minutes. I would prefer you not do it on your 3 training days. I like to keep track of my resting heart rate, and when it is in the low 70s to 60s, I know I am good. Once you get there you can back off completely or bring it down to 1-2 times a week for maintenance.

4) Calorie Balance

It is very important to note that if you are in caloric deficit, you are probably going to slow down muscle growth, and depending on how much the deficit is, impact recovery in a negative way. So be CAREFUL! Lower calorie diets make recovery extremely difficult. Just remember this when building your nutrition plan.

5) Life Stress

Life can be tough, right? Right now, as I type this I am in between moving from one country to another. Jobs are being lost daily; stress is at an all time high for many. Every time I click online, it is essentially people fighting. Whether it's job stress, marital stress, or other stresses, just know that these things can impact recovery in a big way through the constant release of the stress hormone cortisol. The only thing you need to know, is to simply try to manage these things as best you can. Every situation is unique, and there is no silver bullet to solve every issue. One thing I will say is this. If you are struggling, go help somebody else. I think you'll be surprised at how you feel when you help someone else and improve their day, even if in a small way. I would also avoid things you know stress you out, such as comparing yourself to others! Think about what you love to do also. For me it's spending time with my wife. We might go outside for a walk and a movie. Whatever it is you enjoy, that makes you feel great (provided it is legal), focus on that! The last thing I would mention is moving forward when you think you have failed or made a mistake. If you mess up a meal, or miss a session, don't ruminate. Just get over it and get back on track. There is no benefit to beating yourself up over it. Move forward always.

HOW SHOULD I EAT?

I am going to provide some basics here to get you started. These are very general numbers. There are many formulas out there, such as the Harris Benedict equation to help you determine baseline calorie needs, and apps like Cronometer to help you track. I find that people get so caught up in being exactly right with their starting diet, that they don't actually start! I believe the best way to start a meal plan is just get in the ballpark and go. What is going to be most important, is the adjustments you make along the way anyway. So, don't get lost in the minutia, just get to work. Here is a get started\formula for you that will not be perfect but will get you going.

GAIN MUSCLE GOAL:

FOR MEN

- If you are looking for a starting point, then try this:
- Multiply your bodyweight x 16 for your total calories.
- For example, Victor weighs 200 lbs., so this is 3,200 calories daily.
- Multiply your bodyweight x 1 for daily grams of protein.
- The 200 lbs. person thus needs 200 grams of protein daily.
- Multiply your bodyweight x .5 for daily grams of fat.
- The 200 lbs. person thus needs 100 grams of fat daily.
- The rest of your calories should be consumed as carbs.
- In this example, the 200 grams equal 800 calories (a gram of protein = 4 calories.)
- The 100 grams of fat equal 900 calories (a gram of fat = 9 calories.)
- 3,200 total calories minus the 1,700 calories from protein and fat leaves Victor with 1,500 calories.
- 1,500 calories / 4 = 375 grams of carbs. * a gram of carbs equals 4 calories.

FOR WOMEN

• Multiply your bodyweight x 14 for your total calories.

• For example, Susan weighs 125 lbs., so this is 1,750 calories daily. • Multiply your bodyweight x 1 for daily grams of protein.

• The 125 lbs. person thus needs 125 grams of protein daily.
• Multiply your bodyweight x .5 for daily grams of fat.

• The 125 lbs. person thus needs 62.5 grams of fat daily.

• The rest of your calories should be consumed as carbs.

• In this example, the 125 grams equal 500 calories (a gram of protein = 4 calories.) • The 62.5 grams of fat equal 562.5 calories (a gram of fat = 9 calories.)
• 1,750 total calories minus the 1,062.5 calories from protein and fat leaves Susan with 687 calories.

• 687 calories / 4 = 172 grams of carbs. * a gram of carbs equals 4 calories.

NOTE: Women often do a little better with slightly lower carbs and slightly higher fat than men. You can thus adjust the numbers above for females if you like.

LEANER GOAL:

As I said above, it is very important to note that if you are in caloric deficit, you are probably going to slow down muscle growth, and depending on how much the deficit is, impact recovery in a negative way. So be CAREFUL!

If you are looking for a starting point for getting leaner, start with all the above to gain weight!

This may be higher than your normal intake but it's important to build your metabolism so that you have "somewhere to go" with your calories as you hit plateaus. I would advise this for 2 weeks before starting the cutting process. Many times, people are not eating much, so the 1st week is really tough. Once you make it through week 1, week 2 isn't so bad in terms of getting food

down. Then you start the cutting!

I like making adjustments that reflect 10%changes in caloric intake or calories expended (or a combination of the two). So, in the above example Victors' adjustments could be something like this:

- Victor's total calories are 3,250. A 10% change would be an impact of 325 calories.
- 10% net total difference in calories in vs. calories out
- 5% from a reduction in calories via diet changes (162 calories reduced)
- 5% from an increase in caloric expenditure from adding cardio (162 calories expended via cardio)

Continue to make changes more or less aggressively based on results. You may not want to adjust at all, or do another 5%, etc.

If you want a more customized 1-time plan or weekly coaching to get you started, you should have been prompted with an option while making your purchase of the training program. If you missed it, you can always message me @cm.strength on instagram or cmstrength on KakaoTalk

ABOUT CHILI

I was born and raised in Austin, Texas where I found bodybuilding in high school. Texas is home to many great bodybuilders like Ronnie Coleman, Branch Warren, and Steve Kuclo, so I had big shoes to fill and real powerhouses to look up to.

After I started competitive bodybuilding, my journey took me to Korea in 2023 to compete in the Amateur Olympia. From there I met my now wife and moved to Korea, where I hope to help as many individuals discover, learn, and enjoy health and fitness as much as I do.

WEEKS 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11

TRAINING ROTATION

MAKE SURE YOU BRING A NOTEBOOK TO RECORD THE WEIGHTS YOU ARE USING, AND REP COUNTS FOR EACH EXERCISE.

MONDAY – WORKOUT 1

FULL BODY – UPPER BODY EMPHASIS

1/ Incline bench press

This is probably my favorite upper body exercise. It is great for your chest, shoulders, and even hits a little triceps. We are going to work up to 3 sets of 8. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up - Empty bar x 20 reps
> Warm up - 95 lbs. x 15 reps
> Feeder set – 135 lbs. x 4 reps
> Work sets – 185 lbs. for 3 sets of 8

Note: Notice how we did higher reps, but then on to a feeder set to keep from getting fatigued, then did the work sets. This is the warmup pattern we use for the first exercise.

Exercise Index - Low Incline Press

2/ Slight decline dumbbell press

This is another one of my favorite exercises. You will feel zero shoulder stress with these. Simply use a 25 lb. plate to prop up one end of the bench to create the slight decline. I want 3 sets of 8 here. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 45 lb. dumbbells for 4 reps Work sets – 65 lb. dumbbells for 3 sets of 8

Notice how now we only did 1 feeder. You are warmed up so there is no need for the high rep warmups. We just use the feeder set to safely get to your work weight.

Exercise Index - Slight Decline Dumbbell Press

3/ Lat pulldown

I want you to use a slightly wider than shoulder width grip here and bring the bar to the top of your chest. I want you to do 4 sets of 10 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

21 Reasons Why Your Back Isn 't Growing (FIX IT FAST)

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up – 85 lbs. x 20 reps
> Warm up - 105 lbs. x 15 reps
> Feeder set – 125 lbs. x 4 reps
> Work sets – 145 lbs. for 4 sets of 10

4/ Dumbbell side lateral Y raise

I only recently started doing these a couple years ago. Boy was I missing out. This is a great variation of the standard side lateral raise for side delts. You want your hands coming up to 10 and 2 o'clock position, not straight out in front or straight out to the side. Think of it as coming up in between. You'll know when you nail it. I want you to do 3 sets of 10 here. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up set – 5 lb. dumbbells for 15 reps Feeder set – 10 lb. dumbbells for 4 reps Work sets – 15 lb. dumbbells for 3 sets of 10

With only 1-minute rest breaks here, you may need to slightly decrease the weight after the first set. That is ok! It 's just fatigue setting in. Shoulders are a delicate joint so make sure you do one of your higher rep warm up here also.

Exercise Index - Incline Prone Laterals | Less Traps and Wider Shoulders

5/ EZ bar curl

You shouldn't need much warming up here, as you already did some back work. I want you to do 4 sets of 10 here. Lower the bar with a 3 second count, pin your elbows against your sides, and curl strict. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 45 lbs. for 4 reps
> Work sets – 65 lbs. for 4 sets of 10

With only 1-minute rest breaks here, you may lose some reps on the last set or so. That is ok.

6/ Triceps pushdowns

I call these spongy grip pushdowns. I find these to be extremely good for overall triceps development. I want you to do 4 sets of 12 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 85 lbs. for 4 reps
> Work sets – 105 lbs. for 4 sets of 12

Your elbows should be fairly warm by this point, after all the chest work, so we only need feeder sets to get you to your working weight.

With only 1-minute rest breaks here, you may lose some reps on the last set or so. That is ok.

7/ Leg Press

We are in the home stretch now. Hang in there and finish strong! Remember to follow the RPE and leave reps in the tank as specified. Do 4 work sets for 8 reps. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up – 1 plate per side x 20 reps Warm up – 2 plates per side x 15 reps Feeder set – 3 plates per side x 4 reps Work sets – 4 plates per side for 4 sets of 8

Note: You will need several warmup sets as your lower body is not fully warmed up.

8/ Toe presses

Stay in the leg press. You are simply going to do toe presses for your calves. This is the same as a calf raise except in a leg press. Do 3 sets of 15 reps. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up – 1 plate per side x 20 reps Feeder set – 2 plates per side x 4 reps Work sets – 3 plates per side for 3 sets of 15

With only 1-minute rest breaks here, you may lose some reps on the last set or so. That is ok. Get Big Calves | Short On Time Calf Workout

TUESDAY - OFF

WEDNESDAY – WORKOUT 2

FULL BODY – LOWER BODY EMPHASIS

1/ Lying leg curl

My favorite exercise to do before squats is leg curls! Your hips, and knees will feel greased up and ready go, and the blood in your hams will feel awesome as you squat. I want you to do 3 sets of 10 here. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

2/ Squat

Squatting is life! I love squats. I am writing this up as barbell squats, the most basic version. If you have some sort of injury that prevents you from doing them, a dumbell squat is usually a good alternative. Here you are going to work up to a good solid 3 sets of 8. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up – 45 lbs. x 20 reps
> Warm up - 65 lbs. x 15 reps
> Feeder set – 105 lbs. x 4 reps
> Work sets – 135 lbs. for 3 sets of 10
> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up – 95 lbs. x 20 reps
> Warm up - 135 lbs. x 15 reps
> Feeder set – 185 lbs. x 4 reps
> Work sets – 225 lbs. x 3 sets of 8

There are many different versions and I prefer you do the regular barbell back squat if possible.

Very Effective Bodybuilding Leg Workout for MASS |

Exercise Index - Dumbbell Squats

3/ Reverse lunge

You might feel a little fire on these. Take your time and do these with perfect controlled form. Do 3 sets of 10 on each leg. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

Exercise Index - Reverse Lunges

4/ Decline leg raise

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 15 lb. dumbbell/kettlebell x 6 reps Work sets – 25 lb. dumbbell/kettlebell for 3 sets of 10

Let's move on to upper body now with some ab work. Do 4 sets here. For reps, just come shy of failure on each set. That could be 7 reps or 20 reps. These can be tough. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

Exercise Index - Decline Leg Raises

5/ Low cable row

Make sure to pull the bar or cable attachment to your stomach and stay as upright as possible. Do 4 sets of 8 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

YOU ARE Doing the Low Row WRONG (DO IT LIKE THIS)

6/ Hex press

Let's move into some fast-paced chest work now. I want you to do 4 sets of 8 here. Keep the dumbbells together through the entire movement. You can also use a single weight plate and press it in between your hands. This is the key, in addition to flexing hard. This is an example of an exercise that really is good for helping develop mind muscle connection. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

Exercise Index - Hex Press

7/ Bent over laterals

Today we are going to finish up by training one of my favorite muscles, rear delts. Simply bend at the waist and swing the dumbbells out to the side. Do 3 sets of 20. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up set – 25 lb. dumbbells for 15 reps
> Feeder set – 35 lb. dumbbells for 4 reps
> Work sets – 45 lb. dumbbells for 4 sets of 8

Note: I kept the warmup reps low because you are going to need some energy to do 3 sets of 20 here!

Exercise Index - Bent Over Dumbbell Rear Delt Raise

THURSDAY - OFF

FRIDAY – WORKOUT 3

FULL BODY – UPPER BODY EMPHASIS

1/ Meadows row

This is a very demanding exercise, but they are fantastic for adding muscle all over your back. I prefer you to use a barbell and landmine attachment, however you can do a standard dumbbell row but keep your hands pronated. Use 1 arm at a time. We are going to work up to 3 sets of 8. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

Exercise Index - Meadows Row

2/ Dumbbell row

The slight change in form here places more stress on your lats. I want 3 sets of 8 here. Have a base with your feet on the floor too, rather than one knee on the bench which is the traditional way of doing these. I feel my version is safer and more effective. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up - Empty bar x 20 reps
> Warm up – 2 10 lb. plates x 15 reps Feeder set – 3 10 lb. plates x 4 reps Work sets – 4 10 lb. plates for 3 sets of 8
> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 45 lb. dumbbells for 4 reps Work sets – 65 lb. dumbbells for 3 sets of 8

Notice how now we only did 1 feeder. You are warmed up so there is no need for the high rep warmups. We just use the feeder set to safely get to your work weight.

No Low Back Pain Dumbbell Row - Exercise Index

3/ Chest pull

You might be familiar with facepulls, this is a cable variation that works the muscles differently. I prefer to use this style. I want you do 3 sets of 10 here. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minutes

Exercise Index - Chest Pulls

4/ Low cable crossovers

Here is another nice exercise that makes it easy to develop mind muscle connection. I want you to do 4 sets of 10 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

Exercise Index - Low Cable Crossover

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set - 85 x 6 reps
> Work sets - 105 for 3 sets of 10
> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up set – 15 lbs. for 15 reps
> Feeder set – 20 lbs. for 4 reps
> Work sets – 25 lbs. for 4 sets of 10

5/ Preacher curl

I am pretty sure you are going to love these. It is a unique variation that really targets your biceps hard. I want you to do 4 sets of 8 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 15 lb. dumbbells for 6 reps Work sets – 25 lb. dumbbells for 4 sets of 8

With only 1-minute rest breaks here, you may lose some reps on the last set or so. That is ok. Exercise Index - Concentration Preacher Curls

6/ Dumbbell lying tricep extensions

This is another slightly different variation than you normally see. Lay flat on a bench holding dumbbells like you would a bench press. Only bending your elbows, bring the dumbbells down, touch your shoulders, then extend back up. I like this technique for better results. Do 4 sets of 12 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up set – 10 lb. dumbbells for 20 reps Warm up set – 15 lb. dumbbells for 15 reps Work sets – 25 lb. dumbbells for 4 sets of 12

We did some extra warm up reps to ensure your elbows are good and warmed up. You never ever want to go right into a heavy triceps extension, as it is very hard on your elbows.

With only 1-minute rest breaks here, you may lose some reps on the last set or so. That is ok.

7/ Glute bridges

This is an exercise that gets butchered quite a bit. You can also do these with one leg if you like. In that case just place your lead leg on a BOSU ball and drive your hip up through that leg/ glute. Do 4 sets of 10 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

You can do these with bodyweight via one leg. You can use a barbell, or even on a machine such as the booty builder. There are many different variations, but most of all I wanted you to see the range of motion, set up, and execution.

Exercise Index - Hip Thrust "Target the Glutes"

8/ Hyperextensions

You don't need to use a bar bell. I just wanted you to see the type of machine I wanted you to use. This will work your glutes, hams, and low back. It is an excellent exercise. You can hold a dumbbell to make it tougher or even a plate such as a 25 lb. plate. Do 3 sets of 12. Do these nice and slow. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

Exercise Index - Barbell Hyperextensions

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – bodyweight x 10 reps
> Work sets – hold a 25 lb. plate for 3 sets of 12

SATURDAY, SUNDAY - OFF

WEEKS 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12

TRAINING ROTATION

MAKE SURE YOU BRING A NOTEBOOK TO RECORD THE WEIGHTS YOU ARE USING, AND REP COUNTS FOR EACH EXERCISE.

MONDAY – WORKOUT 4

FULL BODY – LOWER BODY EMPHASIS

1/ Leg extensions

Time to get a little bit of a fire burning in those quads. Once warmed up, we are going to do 3 sets of 10. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

Exercise Index - Leg Extension

2/ Lunge

I want you to use kettlebells or dumbbells on these. You can stay more upright or lean forward depending on what you want to work more. The weight will also add some additional stability. Do 3 sets of 10 on each leg. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up – 55 lbs. x 20 reps
> Warm up - 75 lbs. x 15 reps
> Feeder set – 95 lbs. x 4 reps
> Work sets – 135 lbs. for 3 sets of 10
> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 10 lb. dumbbells for 6 steps on each leg
> Work sets – 20 lb. dumbbells for 3 sets of 10 on each leg

Notice how now we only did 1 feeder. You are warmed up so there is no need for the high rep warmups. We just use the feeder set to get you used to the movement.

My "3" Favorite Types of Lunges

3/ Standing calve raise

We can't neglect those calves. Simply place your toes on a weight plate or raised surface. I want you to do 3 sets of 15 here. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

Proper Foot Placement To Build Freaky Calves

4/ Dumbbell Romanian deadlifts

I want you to do both legs at once. Bend at the waist and push your hips back, as if you are touching your toes with the dumbells. I want you to do 3 sets of 10 here. Do these nice and slow, and use perfect form. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up – 55 lbs. x 20 reps
> Feeder set - 85 x 6 reps
> Work sets - 105 for 3 sets of 15
> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up set – 20 lb. dumbbells for 15 reps Feeder set – 30 lb. dumbbells for 4 reps Work sets – 40 lb. dumbbells for 3 sets of 10

One Leg Romanian Style Dumbbell Deadlift for *AMAZING GLUTES*

5/ Incline pushups

Basically, just elevate your legs and keep your back straight. For reps, you 'll be leaving a couple of reps in the tank on these. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

The Perfect 3 Exercise Chest Workout For "Upper Pecs"

6/ Dual rope pushdowns

This is a great version of tricep pushdowns I think you will enjoy. I want you to do 4 sets of 12 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

Exercise Index - Dual Rope Tricep Extensions

7/ Chest supported rows

Find a machine that supports your chest to do these rows. I want you to use a neutral grip if possible, meaning palms facing each other. Do 4 work sets for 8 reps. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

Supported Row for a "THICK BACK" Exercise Index

8/ Sit ups

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up set – Regular pushups
> Work sets – 4 sets

Do 4 sets where you only leave 1 or 2 reps in the tank. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

Exercise Index - How To Do a Proper Sit Up

THURSDAY - OFF

WEDNESDAY – WORKOUT 5

FULL BODY – UPPER BODY EMPHASIS

1/ Flat bench press

This is just a standard barbell bench press. If the bar is too heavy for you, feel free to use dumbbells! I want you to do 3 sets of 8 here. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

21 Reasons Why Your Chest Isn 't Growing (FIX IT NOW)

2/ Pullups

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up – 95 lbs. x 20 reps
> Warm up - 135 lbs. x 15 reps
> Feeder set - 185 x 4 reps
> Work sets - 225 for 3 sets of 8

If you have a hard time doing these, use a machine that assists you, the ones where you can stand on a counterbalance or put your knees on it. You could also use a band to assist. Do 3 sets where you only leave 1 or 2 reps in the tank. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

Exercise Index - Banded Pull Up

3/ Floor press

I really like doing these for both chest and triceps. Do 4 sets of 8 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 135 lbs. x 5 reps
> Feeder set - 225 lbs. x 3 reps
> Work sets - 255 for 4 sets of 8

Note: You already had 2 chest exercises so you should only need a couple feeder sets. Exercise Index - Floor Press For Triceps

4/ Incline dumbbell row

You can use kettlebells or dumbbells. I actually prefer the kettlebell if your gym has them in weight that is heavy enough. Do 4 sets of 8 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 25 lb. dumbbells x 5 reps Work sets – 45 lb. dumbbells for 4 sets of 8

Note: Since you already did pullups your back will be warmed up. Exercise Index | Incline Dumbbell Rows

5/ Hammer curls

Keep your hands in a neutral position for the entire rep. Let's do 4 sets of 10 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 15 lb. dumbbells for 6 reps Work sets – 25 lb. dumbbells for 4 sets of 10

*Note: You did 2 back exercises so your biceps should be plenty warm. 3 Types of Hammer Curls to Build *HUGE* Biceps*

6/ 3 ways

These are sneaky! For these you will raise the dumbbells out to the side, then 10 and 2 o'clock, and finally in front of you. This is 1 rep. Do 3 sets of 5. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 15 lbs. for 2 reps
> Work sets – 25 lbs. for 3 sets of 5

We are going to give the legs a little extra rest today, so they are fresh on Friday! Exercise Index - 6 Ways for Shoulders

THURSDAY - OFF

FRIDAY – WORKOUT 3

FULL BODY – LOWER BODY EMPHASIS

1/ Dumbbell squats

Let's work these hard. Work up to 3 sets of 8 here. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

Exercise Index - Dumbbell Squats

2/ Bulgarian split squat

You may have heard about the Bulgarian Drop Set of Death. Well you aren't quite there yet! Right now, we learn the exercise properly first. This is like a standing lunge except your will place your back leg up on a bench or raised surface like a step block. For now, normal straight sets will work! Do 3 sets of 12 on each leg. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minutes

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up set – 30 lb. dumbbell for 20 reps Warm up set – 50 lb. dumbbell for 15 reps Feeder set – 65 lb. dumbbell for 5 reps Work sets – 85 lb. dumbbell for 3 sets of 8
> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 15 lb. dumbbell for 6 reps Work sets – 35 lb. dumbbell for 3 sets of 12

Notice how now we only did 1 feeder. You are warmed up so there is no need for the high rep warmups. We just use the feeder set to get used to the exercise.

Bulgarian split squats

3/ Pull through

Let's get a little more hams, glutes, and lower back. Do 3 sets of 10 here. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8 | Rest – 3 minute

Exercise Index - Pull Through

4/ Seated calve raises

Do 3 sets of 15 here. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Feeder set – 85 lbs. x 6 reps
> Work sets – 105 lbs. for 3 sets of 10
> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up set – 25 lbs. for 15 reps
> Feeder set – 45 lbs. for 5 reps
> Work sets – 65 lbs. for 3 sets of 15

5/ Machine flyes

When you do machine flys, try to keep your hands at or above your chest for the entire movement. I want you to do 4 sets of 10 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

> Warm up set – 65 lbs. for 15 reps
> Feeder set – 85 lbs. for 5 reps Work sets – 105 lbs. for 4 sets of 10

Basic Heavy Chest Workout For Mass | John Meadows & Seth Shaw

6/ Dumbbell pullover

These will hit your back and chest. Let's do 4 sets of 10 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

Dumbbell Pullovers for a Thick Chest (MUST TRY)

7/ Reverse curl

These are simply using a pronated grip (palms down) when you curl instead of supinated (palms up). This hits more forearm along with biceps. Do 4 sets of 10 here. 4 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

8/ Tate press

This is a cool triceps variation I think you'll enjoy. Lay on a bench and using 1 arm, hold the dumbbell in front of you like a bench press and bending only your elbow, touch your opposite shoulder and extend the weight back up. You can use a dumbbell if you do not have a suitable kettlebell. Do 3 sets of 12 here. 3 total work sets

RPE - 8.5 | Rest – 1 minute

Exercise Index - Kettlebell Tate Press For Triceps

> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up set – 20 lb. dumbbell for 15 reps Feeder set – 30 lb. dumbbell for 5 reps Work sets – 40 lb. dumbbell for 4 sets of 10
> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up set – 25 lbs. for 15 reps
> Feeder set – 35 lbs. for 5 reps
> Work sets – 45 lbs. for 4 sets of 10
> This is an example of what it could look like:
> Warm up set – 10 lb. dumbbell for 15 reps Feeder set – 15 lb. dumbbell for 5 reps Work sets – 20 lb. dumbbell for 3 sets of 12